TOPIC REPORTS: STANDARDS

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

News, Sep – Oct 2026

STRATEGIES, PLANS AND POLICIES · LEGISLATION AND REGULATION · DATA PROTECTION · REGIONAL COLLABORATION · STANDARDS · PUBLIC DEBATE AND PARTICIPATION IN POLICYMAKING

Benin · Burkina Faso · Burundi · Cameroon · Congo · Egypt · Ethiopia · Gabon · Gambia · Ghana · Kenya · Liberia · Libya · Mali · Mauritania · Mauritius · Namibia · Nigeria · Rwanda · Seychelles · South Sudan · Sudan · Tanzania · Togo · Tunisia · Zambia

Benin

NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY RÉFÉRENTIEL FOR AI SYSTEMS

- **Transformation numérique : Le Bénin veut accélérer avec l'IA et miser sur ses propres talents** — CADRECO, 9 October 2026

  Benin's public-sector digital chiefs met in Cotonou on 8 October 2026 at a conference now covering digital transformation and innovation, where an AI cybersecurity framework with four risk tiers, an AI officer and an ethics committee was presented. Officials cited shortages of staff, equipment, servers and funding in administrations, and the minister stressed developing local solutions and talent.

Burkina Faso

NATIONAL STANDARDISATION, METROLOGY AND QUALITY AGENCY

- **ISO - ABNORM - Agence Burkinabé de Normalisation, de Métrologie et de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

  ISO lists ABNORM as Burkina Faso's member body and sole national standards developer. It participates in 9 ISO technical committees and observes 5.

Burundi

ISO MEMBERSHIP OF THE NATIONAL STANDARDS BUREAU

- **ISO - BBN - Bureau Burundais de Normalisation et Contrôle de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

  ISO's member page lists the Bureau Burundais de Normalisation et Contrôle de la Qualité (BBN) as Burundi's member body. As read in October 2026, it participates in 11 ISO technical committees and observes 28.

Cameroon

ANOR, THE NATIONAL STANDARDS BODY

- **ISO - ANOR - Agence des Normes et de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

ISO lists Cameroon's Agence des Normes et de la Qualité (ANOR) as a member body. As read in October 2026, it participates in 4 technical committees and observes 41.

Congo

ACONOQ, THE NATIONAL STANDARDS AND QUALITY AGENCY

- **ISO - ACONOQ - Agence Congolaise de Normalisation et de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

  ISO lists ACONOQ, created by a 2015 law, as the Republic of Congo's national standards body and ISO member. It is a member of ARSO and an Affiliate Plus of the IEC, and participates in 2 ISO technical committees.

Egypt

REGULATOR'S SMART AND SUSTAINABLE CITIES ASSESSMENT PLATFORM

- **تنظيم الاتصالات: منظومة لتقييم المدن الذكية والمستدامة وفق معايير دولية** — Youm7, 15 October 2026

  Egypt's telecoms regulator described an online system that scores new cities against its smart and sustainable cities code and issues conformity certificates. It is applied with the housing ministry to cities including the New Administrative Capital and New Alamein.

Ethiopia

CENTRAL BANK DIRECTIVE ON MICROFINANCE DIGITAL READINESS (MFI/33/2022)

- **When Digital Ambition Becomes a Tripping Stone** — Capital (Ethiopia), 6 September 2026

  In an opinion piece, microfinance practitioner Surafel Teshome argues that some Ethiopian microfinance institutions are buying mobile wallets and agent channels before they have the strategy, systems and governance to run them. He points to the National Bank of Ethiopia's Directive MFI/33/2022, which requires an IT strategy, board oversight, risk assessment, disaster recovery and IT audit.

Gabon

IPV6 TRANSITION AWARENESS

- **Internet : AFRINIC sensibilise l'écosystème gabonais aux enjeux de l'IPv6** — GabonReview, 10 September 2026

  The regional internet registry presented its mission and programmes to Gabon's technical community at a workshop in Libreville, held at the initiative of the national internet exchange point. The session focused on the transition to IPv6 as IPv4 addresses run out, and on the registry's role in a more accessible and secure African internet.

Gambia

THE GAMBIA STANDARDS BUREAU

- **ISO - TGSB - The Gambia Standards Bureau** — International Organization for Standardization, 3 September 2026

  The Gambia Standards Bureau holds Correspondent, non-voting status at the international standards and electrotechnical organisations, and is the country's technical-barriers enquiry point. A correspondent member may adopt standards; it does not help make them.

Ghana

CYBER AND INFORMATION SECURITY DIRECTIVE 2026

- **BoG orders banks to give fraud units direct access to CEOs** — MyJoyOnline, 6 October 2026

  The Bank of Ghana directed banks to give their fraud units direct and unrestricted access to the managing director or chief executive, Governor Johnson Asiama told heads of banks. He said fraud staff must hold the right skills and certifications, and that the central bank will tighten supervision of technology, customer-fund safeguarding and third-party risk. The meeting date is not given.

- **BoG develops AI rules for financial sector** — MyJoyOnline, 11 October 2026

  The Bank of Ghana is drafting a directive on the use of artificial intelligence by financial institutions, its governor told the banks' annual meeting. The Bank will also run thematic reviews of how banks have implemented its revised cyber and information security directive.

MEDICAL RECORDS STRATEGY AND OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES

- **Preparing Ghana's health records for the digital future** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 12 October 2026

  The Ghana Health Service, supported by WHO, convened a national workshop to revise its Medical Records Strategy and Operational Guidelines, written nearly a decade ago. The revision is to cover electronic medical records, data governance, interoperability, cybersecurity and the use of artificial intelligence in healthcare.

GOVERNMENT DATA EXCHANGE HUB

- **Ghana targets $5bn in annual economic gains from AI – Sam George** — MyJoyOnline, 15 October 2026

  Ghana's communications minister said the government has committed US$270 million to its AI plans, US$250 million of it for the first phase of a national AI compute centre and US$20 million for an AI fund, and targets about US$5 billion a year in economic gains. He said the ministry is building a data exchange hub to connect 48 government registries.

Kenya

NATIONAL INFORMATION SECURITY FRAMEWORK AUDIT AND RISK TOOLKITS

- **ICT Authority steps up protection of Govt systems, critical information infrastructure** — Education News (Kenya), 7 September 2026

  Kenya's technology authority put the National Information Security Framework's audit, risk-management and certification mechanisms to a Nairobi stakeholder workshop, to establish whether they are practical for national implementation ahead of certifying critical information infrastructure. The framework text and the certification criteria are not published.

CENTRAL BANK GUIDANCE NOTE ON AI FOR THE BANKING SECTOR

- **Central Bank of Kenya - Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025** — Central Bank of Kenya, 22 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Kenya's Bank Supervision Annual Report 2025, published on 22 September 2026, reports a March 2025 survey in which 50% of supervised institutions had adopted artificial intelligence, including 66% of commercial banks, and 30% had formal AI strategies. Credit risk assessment was the commonest use. The bank plans an AI guidance note for the sector.

MEMBERSHIP OF THE INTERNATIONAL STANDARDS ORGANISATION

- **ISO - KEBS - Kenya Bureau of Standards** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

ISO lists the Kenya Bureau of Standards (KEBS), set up under the Standards Act in 1974, as Kenya's member body. It holds one technical committee secretariat, participates in 129 committees and observes 177.

Liberia

STATUTORY SCHOOL RECORD-KEEPING BOOKLET

- **Liberia: Ministry Moves to Standardize School Records Nationwide** — Ministry of Education, Liberia (via APO Group), 13 September 2026

  Liberia's Ministry of Education opened a five-day session in Kakata to develop and validate a Statutory School Record-Keeping Booklet, one nationwide system for school records on students, teachers, attendance and infrastructure. County teams are then to finalise education operational plans from the 2024/25 school census fact sheets.

Libya

HIGH TECHNICAL COMMITTEE FOR THE NATIONAL INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **During its sixth regular meeting in Tripoli, the High Technical Committee for the National Information System reviewed financial indicators and established rules for membership and future work** — General Information Authority (Libya), 6 September 2026

  Libya's High Technical Committee for the National Information System met in Tripoli on 1 September 2026 and ruled that permanent membership belongs to the director of each ministry's information and documentation centre, with proxies accepted only by official letter in emergencies. The finance ministry's information centre presented national financial-sector indicators and how they are produced.

Mali

MALIAN STANDARDISATION AND QUALITY PROMOTION AGENCY

- **ISO - AMANORM - Agence Malienne de Normalisation et de Promotion de la Qualité** — Organisation internationale de normalisation (ISO), 3 September 2026

  The International Organization for Standardization's member record lists Mali's standards agency AMANORM as a full member body and the country's national standards body. AMANORM coordinates standardisation, quality promotion, certification and accreditation, and is also part of ECOWAS's standards harmonisation programme (ECOSHAM), ECOWAS quality policy (ECOQUAL) and the UEMOA quality policy. The page carries no date.

Mauritania

TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE ON PUBLIC FINANCE STATISTICS AND STATE-ENTERPRISE DEBT

- **Le ministre des Finances recoit une mission d'assistance technique du FMI** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 3 September 2026

  Mauritania's finance minister, Codioro Moussa N'Guénore, received an IMF technical assistance mission from AFRITAC West in Nouakchott. The mission works on compiling public finance statistics and public enterprise debt in line with the IMF's 2014 Government Finance Statistics Manual, including the collection and consolidation of state enterprises' financial data.

NATIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR PUBLIC DIGITAL SERVICE STANDARDS

- **إطلاق برنامج تكويني لتوحيد معايير البنية الرقمية للدولة** — الإعلام نت (Elilam), 28 September 2026

Mauritania's digital ministry opened a week-long training for its officials and 120 new staff on applying unified state digital-infrastructure standards to every new digital service, following a March consultation of 34 ministerial sectors under the Digital-Y project. The ministry says the national government cloud now hosts state services and its design system is in use internally ahead of wider rollout.

ISO MEMBERSHIP (NATIONAL STANDARDS OFFICE)

- **ISO - ONANOR - Office National de la Normalisation et det la Métrologie** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

  ISO lists Mauritania's ONANOR as a correspondent member, participating in 5 technical committees and observing 10 as of October 2026. The page's description still names an older directorate under the mines and industry ministry.

Mauritius

DIGITAL SERVICE FRAMEWORK

- **Digital Service Framework to strengthen Government digital services** — Government Information Service, Mauritius, 1 September 2026

  Mauritius will develop a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service, from planning through operation, binding all services developed, procured or maintained by ministries. Cabinet noted it on 28 August; no compliance date is set.

Namibia

HARMONISED GOVERNMENT COMMUNICATION STRATEGY

- **Namibia's economic armoury: How new government communication strategy could unlock multibillion-dollar investment** — Business Express, 13 September 2026

  Namibia's ICT minister Emma Theofelus launched the Harmonised Government Communication Strategy 2026–2030 and the Government Corporate Brand Identity Manual at the public administration institute NIPAM on 9 September 2026. Cabinet approved both in March 2026; they set a single voice and brand for ministries, agencies, regional and local authorities and public enterprises.

MEMBERSHIP OF THE INTERNATIONAL STANDARDS ORGANISATION

- **ISO - NSI - Namibian Standards Institution** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026

  ISO lists the Namibian Standards Institution, set up under the Standards Act 2005, as Namibia's member body. As of October 2026 it participates in 21 technical committees and observes 23.

Nigeria

DEVICE MANAGEMENT SYSTEM AND TYPE APPROVAL ENFORCEMENT

- **Device Mgt System won't expose users' data - NCC** — Vanguard, 9 September 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission said on 9 September 2026 that its new Device Management System will not give it access to users' personal data or communications. The system records IMEI numbers to check that SIM-enabled devices have type approval, and unregistered devices will be barred from networks. The first phase, with the customs service and importers, covers devices already in stock and new imports.

- **Stakeholders Push for Extension of DMS Implementation Timeline, Seek Clarification on Grey Areas** — ThisDay, 9 September 2026

Mobile device manufacturers asked the Nigerian Communications Commission to extend the timetable for its Device Management System, which checks each device's IMEI against registers of stolen or counterfeit handsets before activation. The commission plans to charge about N670 per IMEI and over N3,700 for high-end devices, with free onboarding of existing stock closing on 7 September. Manufacturers said the window was too short and the appeal procedure unclear.

- **NCC Moves to Strengthen Type Approval Compliance for SIM-enabled Devices** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026

  Nigeria's communications regulator is strengthening enforcement of type approval for SIM-enabled devices through a technology-enabled framework, supported by a device management system that determines compliance electronically. The underlying obligation is in the communications statute, which requires approval before a device may be connected.

- **TYPE APPROVAL ENFORCEMENT: Why your phone may stop working soon** — Vanguard, 11 September 2026

  The Nigerian Communications Commission has begun implementing a Device Management System that checks whether SIM-enabled devices meet its type-approval rules, using a central register of IMEI numbers, Vanguard reported on 11 September 2026. The first phase registers devices in stock and new imports with the Nigeria Customs Service; non-compliant and stolen devices can be blocked from networks. The commission says the system gives it no access to device contents.

- **NCC Deploys 8,526 Telecom Sites, Vows to End Call Masking** — Voice of Nigeria, 12 September 2026

  Nigeria's mobile operators have built 8,526 of 12,179 committed coverage and capacity sites, about 70%, up from around 5,000 at the previous meeting, the Nigerian Communications Commission board said after its 110th meeting. The board also said its Device Management System is live, allowing stolen devices to be blocked across networks, and restated zero tolerance for call masking.

- **Nigeria's Phone Crackdown: Protecting Networks or Pricing Out Everyday Users?** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026

  From 10 October 2026, Nigeria's communications regulator began texting owners of phones not verified under type approval that network access could be blocked after 30 days of active use. The checks run on the NCC's Device Management System against each phone's IMEI, and grey-market and overseas-bought phones are among those flagged. A registration route and official fees had not been clearly published by 16 October.

Rwanda

STANDARDS TECHNICAL COOPERATION AGREEMENT WITH ZAMBIA

- **Zambia, Rwanda sign technical cooperation agreement to harmonise standards** — Zambia Monitor, 3 September 2026 ZAMBIA

  The Zambia Bureau of Standards and the Rwanda Standards Board signed a technical cooperation agreement at the 32nd African Organisation for Standardisation General Assembly in Mombasa. It covers information exchange, joint technical committees, mutual recognition of standards and conformity assessment results, and support in standards development.

INTERNATIONAL ICT STANDARDS COMMITTEE PARTICIPATION

- **International and regional technical committees** — Rwanda Standards Board, 16 October 2026

The Rwanda Standards Board lists the regional and international technical committees it sits on, including EAC standards committees. Among them, it is a participating member of the ISO/IEC JTC 1 subcommittee on IT service management (SC 40), an observer on JTC 1 and its security subcommittee SC 27, and a member of the EAC committee on IT standards.

Seychelles

GOVERNMENT-WIDE INTEROPERABILITY STANDARDS (DICT POLICY, STANDARDS AND RESEARCH SECTION)

- **Policy, Standards & Research Section** — Department of Information Communications Technology (DICT), Government of Seychelles, 1 September 2026

  Seychelles' Department of Information Communications Technology sets out the mandate of its Policy, Standards and Research Section: technical and coding standards for interoperable e-government services, integration of government applications and databases, and management of Gov Mail, the government intranet and the e-services portal. The page is undated.

South Sudan

PARTICIPATION IN THE AFRICAN COMMON POSITIONS FOR WRC-27

- **South Sudan Advances Satellite Connectivity Agenda at African Telecom Meeting** — TechAfrica News, 17 September 2026 AFRICA

  South Sudan's National Communication Authority took part in the third African preparatory meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, held in Tunisia. Non-geostationary satellite systems and direct-to-device connectivity were among the items African regulators worked on for common regional positions.

Sudan

ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF STANDARDS-CERTIFICATION FEES

- **«المواصفات بالنيل الأبيض تدشن التحصيل الإلكتروني عبر برنامج «إيصالي** — الرادار نيوز (Al Radar News), 15 September 2026

  The standards and metrology body's White Nile branch began collecting fees electronically, issuing a receipt at the moment of payment, presented as enforcement of a state-wide electronic collection decision.

Tanzania

ZANZIBAR GUIDELINE ON TELECOMMUNICATIONS INFRASTRUCTURE PLACEMENT AND SHARING

- **Serikali yaandaa mwongozo kudhibiti utitiri wa nguzo za fiber mitaani** — Mwananchi, 9 September 2026

  Zanzibar's deputy minister for communications, Mohamed Sijamin Mohamed, told the House of Representatives on 9 September 2026 that the government is drafting a guideline on installing and sharing communications infrastructure. It responds to the spread of street poles erected by each internet provider for fibre-to-the-home. The guideline would promote a single fibre contractor or shared poles. No date for adoption is given.

Togo

AGENCE TOGOLAISE DE NORMALISATION

- **ISO - ATN - Agence Togolaise de Normalisation** — International Organization for Standardization (ISO), 4 September 2026

The International Organization for Standardization lists Togo's standards agency, the Agence Togolaise de Normalisation, as a full member body. It takes part in ISO's technical and policy development committees as an observing member only. The entry is undated.

ARCHITECTURE D'ENTREPRISE GOUVERNEMENTALE DU TOGO

- **Eléments structurants de l'architecture nationale — Documentation Architecture d'Entreprise Gouvernementale du Togo** — Agence Togo Digital / Ministère de l'Économie Numérique et de la Transformation Digitale, République Togolaise, 4 September 2026

  Agence Togo Digital's documentation sets out the Togo Government Enterprise Architecture, the standard the state's information systems are to be built against. It lists a vision, orientation statements and principles including single authoritative registers, no re-collection of data the state already holds, open standards and interoperability.

- **Contrôle des modifications du document — Guide de l'Architecture d'Entreprise Gouvernementale du Togo** — ATD (Agence Togo Digital), 6 September 2026

  Togo's government enterprise-architecture guide, and with it the common interoperability framework it defines, is still a draft on the digital agency's own live status page: version 1.0, status Brouillon, with the version date, reviewer and review date fields blank and the revision table carrying only its column headers. The framework exists as a published normative text and has not been given force of law.

MINIMUM 95 PER CENT QUALITY-OF-SERVICE COMPLIANCE RULE

- **Togo's Mobile Quality Results Show YAS Ahead Nationally, MAT Leading on 4G** — Togo First, 27 September 2026

  Togo's telecoms regulator found neither mobile operator meeting its quality-of-service standards in a national campaign across 86 locations from July to August 2026, with YAS at about 75% compliance and Moov Africa Togo at about 54%. It is drafting rules that would require 95% compliance nationwide, backed by penalties.

Tunisia

HOSTING OF THE THIRD AFRICAN PREPARATORY MEETING FOR WRC-27

- **African Delegations Demand Common Ground In Tunis Ahead Of 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference** — Cyber Era, 17 September 2026 AFRICA

  African governments and regulators opened four days of talks in Tunis to build common positions on the radio frequencies used by mobile, satellite and other wireless services, ahead of the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference. Broadband capacity, rural connectivity and future communications technologies are the focus.

G-CLOUD AND N-CLOUD PROVIDER LABELS

- **Cybersécurité et entreprises : ce qui va changer pour les entreprises publiques et leurs fournisseurs privés** — Webmanagercenter (WMC), 22 September 2026

  An analysis of Tunisia's circular of 2 September 2026 on public-sector cybersecurity says it obliges public enterprises to adopt multi-factor authentication, DDoS protection, regular audits, backups and business continuity measures, creating recurring costs. The national cybersecurity agency's list of 17 September names only six qualified N-Cloud providers. New continuity and recovery requirements are announced from 1 January 2027.

Zambia

STANDARDS TECHNICAL COOPERATION AGREEMENT WITH RWANDA

- **Zambia, Rwanda sign technical cooperation agreement to harmonise standards** — Zambia Monitor, 3 September 2026 RWANDA

  The Zambia Bureau of Standards and the Rwanda Standards Board signed a technical cooperation agreement at the 32nd African Organisation for Standardisation General Assembly in Mombasa. It covers information exchange, joint technical committees, mutual recognition of standards and conformity assessment results, and support in standards development.

NATIONAL PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE AND DIGITAL TRUST ANCHOR

- **Zambia Bets on Digital Trust** — Zambia24, 7 September 2026

  The communications regulator has operationalised the National Digital Trust Anchor as national root certification authority, under the electronic communications and transactions statute. The framework is to issue and verify the certificates and signatures that establish who a person or organisation is online. No certificate count, list of subordinate authorities or accreditation route accompanies the launch.

- **Zambia launches national digital trust infrastructure** — ITWeb Africa, 9 September 2026

  Zambia and Altron Security have launched a National Public Key Infrastructure, intended as a sovereign root of trust for digital identity, electronic signatures and secure online government, with certificates carrying legal validity under the country's electronic communications and transactions law. The master cryptographic keys were generated under independently audited conditions in a purpose-built facility and are held offline, split among several custodians so that no single body controls them. The Smart Zambia Institute's national coordinator said the launch is only the beginning and its value depends on whether government can sustain the infrastructure, fund it and get public institutions to adopt it.

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